

OREGON CITY COURIER

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A WORTHY BOYCOTT

A subject that has received many columns of press space, both as news and editorial matter, within the past fortnight, is the high cost of living. Since the days of the proverbial pup, Hec, the high cost of living has been on the tip of the housewife's tongue, yet the cost continues to go skyward at an alarming rate. Insane politicians have told us with all sincerity that the president had the power to control this flight and congressional committees have battled bravely to understand and regulate it.

But it is only within the past fortnight that the housewife has come into a full understanding of the situation. It is only in that time that she has realized to any extent her great power in controlling the cost of food. She is just now coming into the knowledge that she alone has the power to regulate the cost of necessities and it appears that she is going to exercise that power in no uncertain manner.

"Boycott" is a terrible word, but it signifies, when properly applied, a service to society—the society of hovel and mansion alike. And a boycott is what the housewives of America are planning. May their plans succeed against the wily criminals whose hold on the purse strings of the nation's homes has lasted successfully through these many generations.

Just pause for a moment and consider where that noble Chicago gentleman whose massive warehouses hold 6,000,000 dozen eggs in storage would get off if the housewives of America boycotted his eggs and the eggs of other schemers who defy the world and say "the public must pay the price." This Chicago gentleman tells us that he was "stung" last year, but that he has been educated, has bought all the eggs he could get and will sit tight on the lid of his cold storage plant and wait for the season's highest price before he sells a single egg. Worthy citizen of a free country, how proud you must be of your intellectual self?

Turkeys, just before Thanksgiving day, advanced to such an excessive price in Clackamas county as well as elsewhere that only those homes whose incomes could take care of luxuries could eat of the festive bird. The housewife has only herself to blame if such a thing happens again. The housewife now has only herself to blame if eggs sell at 50 and 60 cents a dozen. Let her boycott the dealer, who in turn must boycott the commission merchant who is holding great stocks of the necessities of life for higher prices, and we will see that beautiful day when the cost of living shall have resumed its normal plane and we shall be able to understand the reason for banks, to whose vaults our money has been a stranger since living went to visit Mars.

When eggs, meat, potatoes or any other article of food gets to such a price that its cost is utterly unreasonable the housewife should conspire with her sisters throughout the land and refuse absolutely to buy until prices were lower. There isn't a dealer or commission merchant in the land who could withstand the con-

certed boycott of the housewives union. The dealer usually isn't at fault. He buys from the commission merchant and must pay the price and sell at a corresponding price. The housewife has the commission merchant and the speculator under her thumb and all that is needed is bear down heavily upon the defiant, prostrate form is the united action of those who manage the home. We would like to see the women squash the very life out of the food speculator and others responsible, for he is an animal of fendish design, unfit to live among us.

The producer will not suffer through a boycott directed by the housewife. The producer today gets next to nothing for the commodity that brings the speculator so much profit. The producer would get as much or more for his wares as he does now, but the margin of profit between the producer and the speculator would be reduced. Let us have a boycott.

WHAT IS A CONVICT

Now that the old order has been changed at the state penitentiary and the new warden, Charles A. Murphy, has been quietly inducted into office, we would like to direct a question to Governor James Withycombe and hope for a personal answer. Will the governor please state for the edification of his constituents just what is a convict?

Between Governor Withycombe and a pack of furbelowed reformers we have gained the idea that a convict is a favored sort of a citizen whose crime, heinous as it may have been, is the purchase price of a meal ticket for life; the cost of a warmer, more springy bed than his more favored brother on the outside can enjoy; the cost of a perennial pass to the evening moving picture show; plenty of tobacco and equipment for the whole calendar of sports, with a little labor thrown in occasionally to tone up the muscles and regulate the digestive apparatus.

The thief, the murderer, the beguiler, the seducer, the arson fiend—the general riff-raff of the lawless element whose defiance of society has taken the form of a crime, hob-nob with the unfortunate sinner who went astray on life's devious path and who is forced by the grim hand of "justice" to live his life behind the iron bars. The thief and the murderer sleep upon the same bed with the poor devil who grasped a crust of bread from the corner grocery to keep his baby from starvation; the thief and the murderer eat at the same table, they laugh at the same moving picture comic and they enjoy the same good reading matter. And, like as not, they will be paroled as soon as the man who stole a chicken to make broth for his dying wife.

And then comes a heathenish, inhumanly cruel and morally perverse warden. He studies the criminals and their crimes. He lives among them, seeing into their natures and watching their actions. He picks out the uncontrollable ones, the men whose hearts are steeped in sin and whose minds are a mass of evil thought—whose souls know nothing

clean or pure. These men—there are many of them in our prison—regard the rule of their comfortable home more as a joke than anything else and they defy their warden. And the hose is turned on them.

Poor warden! he is up against it. He can only tell these nice, clean, sociable thieves and murderers that they are disobedient. He cannot even so much as slap them on their dainty wrists. He plays the fifty-fifty game throughout. If the prisoners are perfect gentlemen the warden will be a gentleman. If they treat him with respect and don't talk back to him, the warden will be very good to the prisoners. But if the prisoners are bad boys and don't mind their law-father then the warden—yes, then!—he'll be good to them in any case, and will take them to Sunday's chicken dinner and to the evening picture show just the same as if they had been very, very good. The governor's orders! The good prisoners are no better than the bad prisoners and the nature of the crime is not the gauge of prison freedom, for the warden must simply be the warden in any case.

Along comes the one warden, amid many changes of prison administration, who has the temerity, the sense of right, to turn the hose on a few of the vile wretches whose crimes are too heinous to record. He measures a man by his crime and by his action in the prison. He finds a few of them disobedient to every authority and defiant of every order. He turns the hose on them.

Good-bye, warden, the governor's going to get your scalp. And a new warden, a fifty-fifty gentleman who plays square as long as the convict is square—and after that plays square anyhow, is politely shown into the commodious quarters of his predecessor and told to take charge. Now mind you, warden, if you dare to turn the hose on one of the vicious brutes behind the bars in our prison you will have your official title annulled in no time at all. A convict comes to our prison to be made into a perfect gentleman through frequent attendance at the picture show, the baseball game, the library, the dining room and very, very seldom at the workshop. Your free meal ticket lasts as long as you are good and when you are bad we will feed you just the same. We shall never, never think of turning the hose on you to prevent you from murdering a harmless little guard and we'll have clean sheets on your bed every week.

Let us hope that Charles A. Murphy has the backbone to order a hosing when a hosing is needed to calm the inflamed spirits of his charges. He will lose his official head, but we will shortly run out of the supply of wardens and will have to put up with a man brave enough to treat his charges in accordance with their merits. If they are bad slap them on their pretty wrists. If they are good give them an extra ticket to our nice warm picture show. Sure, the taxpayer will kick at the bill of entertainment, for Oregon's prison is a comfortable home for indigent citizens. It is not—and so help James Withycombe, it never will be—a place for the punishment of those men and women who find it inconvenient to uphold the laws of the state.

WE RISE TO REMARK

There is a little lesson in loyalty that should be brought home to Oregon City and Clackamas county with the approach of another gay Christmas season. It is the lesson we have heard these many years and so frequently that its repetition grates upon our nerves until we would like to throw from us the paper that carries the message, "Trade at Home." It is simple and it is overworked. Yet there are very few more trading at home today than there were last year or the years before that.

Gradually, though, the spirit of loyalty will get under our hides and Oregon City and Clackamas county will get its just return of the money we earn here. More than ever before the merchants of this city and county have stocked their shelves in advance for the business of the Christmas season. There is in the stores of this city and county an array of Christmas wares that has no superior, even in Portland. It may be a more limited stock, but it is here in quantity sufficient to supply our every need.

The local merchant has built up a splendid business by the sheer weight of his confidence in the city and county. He is spending the money he earns to build up the city and he is paying wages to local people. Yet there are those who would prefer to do their Christmas shopping in Portland for the mere sake of getting in the madly pushing throngs about the bargain counters. There are few bargain counters in Oregon City. The margin of profit on goods sold here is smaller than in Portland, where merchants suffer from excessive overhead, and the best can be had here for the price of the cheapest in Portland.

It is a duty we owe to our city and its future to spend our Christmas money at home. Our business cannot thrive while our citizens spend their money in the metropolis and it is high time that we turned our full attention to home trade. We realize what a tiresome song "buy it in Oregon City" gets to be after you have heard it for the 'steenth time, but if we would all adopt the slogan the necessity for it would disappear.

Just pay a visit to your home stores, no matter what your Christmas wants may be, and we will warrant that you will find it as easily and as reasonably supplied as it could be in Portland. You don't find the Portland merchants bringing any money back to Oregon City for investment and there appears no logical reason why Clackamas county people should spend their money, earned here, to build up Portland at the expense of our own cities and towns.

The Courier and the Daily Journal \$4.75.

SHIVELY OPERA HOUSE, DEC. 14--15

2:45—TWICE DAILY—8:15

THE ELLIOTT & SHERMAN FILM CORPORATION (H. S. SHERMAN, PRESIDENT) PRESENTS
THE WORLD'S GREATEST—MOST SUCCESSFUL—AMERICAN PLAY
DAVID W. GRIFFITH'S MASTERPIECE

Cost \$500,000

18,000 People

M
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2:45

PRICES

25c

50c

3,000 Horses

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8:15

PRICES

50c

75c

\$1.00

Scenes, 5,000

ACCOMPANIED BY THEIR OWN GRAND

SYMPHONY ORCHESTRA

MILLIONS HAVE SEEN IT AND MILLIONS WILL SEE IT AGAIN AND AGAIN
THE "MASTER-CRAFT" OF "FILM PERFECTION"

SEAT SALE OPENS SATURDAY, DECEMBER 9th AT

JONES DRUG STORE

25c Per Month is the Average Cost of Operating a Mitchell Water System

Don't Envy the City Man's Home Make Him Envy Yours!

The city man envies the ruralite for his pure air, his elbow room and his broad gauge life in general but he pities him for one thing—His Water Supply. A few years ago and this pity was well founded, but now the shoe is on the other foot.

THE Mitchell Water System

The MITCHELL SYSTEM enables you

To use as MUCH water as you wish WHEN YOU WISH, to have as MANY faucets as you want WHERE you want them at no extra cost; to regulate your own pressure—as MUCH or as LITTLE as you wish; to use your water for gardening—irrigating—sprinkling or for whatever other purpose you may desire. That's why a MITCHELL WATER SYSTEM gives you the best of the City Man.

The Mitchell Water System supplies you with unlimited dependable supply of pure cool water at no more cost (usually not as much) per month than is paid by the average city man for his restricted supply. This is not so of other water systems, which often are a source of a great deal more trouble than satisfaction owing to improper construction or poor installation. We have installed hundreds of Mitchell Systems in all parts of the Northwest—they are giving satisfaction to every buyer. We, if given the opportunity, will gladly give you the benefit of our six years' experience in the pneumatic water supply line. We will plan for your home a Mitchell System that will exactly fit your requirements—that will give you water which will please you now and continue to do so for years and years—that's our policy—COMPLETE AND PERMANENT SATISFACTION TO EVERY BUYER—and we have the goods that uphold every claim we make for them. Write us today for our free book on country and suburban water supply systems. Ask for book.

Stover Engines
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PORTLAND - OREGON
Spokane BoiseMR. REYNOLDS of
Clackamas, Oregon, has
a MITCHELL SYSTEM.

W. J. WILSON & CO., Oregon City Agent

BURNS IS APPOINTED

Former Oregon City Policeman Will
Become Deputy Warden at Pen

Charles E. Burns, for 18 years chief of police in Oregon City, has been advised of his appointment as deputy warden of the state penitentiary under Warden Charles A. Murphy. Mr. Burns will take up his new duties with the retirement of Deputy Warden Sherwood on January 1. Mr. Burns was one of the foremost candidates for the position Mr. Murphy was selected to fill.

The new deputy warden was deputy United States marshal for eight years and he also served Clackamas county as a deputy recorder for two years. Mr. Burns was born in Oregon City and is 61 years old. Practically his entire life has been spent in this city. The selection of an assistant was left with Mr. Murphy when he was appointed to succeed Warden Minto and he turned immediately to Mr. Burns.

As a police officer and as deputy United States marshal Mr. Burns achieved a reputation as a police officer and his friends are confident that

he will make a creditable record in his new position.

Circuit Court Orders

A default decree was entered Tuesday in favor of J. C. and M. H. Kaupisch in their action against Preston and Michael Pendleton et al, to quiet claims to property here.

J. B. McFarland won judgment Tuesday from S. Masters in the sum of \$340, with interest at 8 per cent and \$50 attorneys' fees.

A judgment of \$150, with interest

at 8 per cent and \$25 attorneys' fees was entered Tuesday in favor of Matt Didner in his suit against R. E. Morrell, administrator of the estate of Louis Morrell.

The suit of C. E. Somers against Nathan E. Harvey was dismissed upon motion of attorneys for Mr. Somers.

Our Jitney Offer—This and 5c DON'T MISS THIS. Cut out this slip, enclose with 5c and mail it to Foley & Co., 2835 Sheffield Ave., Chicago, Ill., writing your name and address clearly. You will receive in return a trial package containing Foley's Honey and Tar Compound, for coughs, colds and croup; Foley Kidney Pills, for pain in sides and back, rheumatism, backache, kidney and bladder ailments; and Foley Cathartic Tablets, a wholesome and thoroughly cleansing cathartic, for constipation, biliousness, headache and sluggish bowels.—Jones Drug Co.

Courier and Daily Journal—\$4.75.

S&H STAMPS GIVEN

STRONG
VALUESLion Clothing Co.
MORRISON AT 4TH

Double S. & H. Green Trading Stamps given when this ad is presented within ten days of date. EQUAL TO CASH DISCOUNT.



S&H STAMPS GIVEN

SUITS
OVERCOATS
RAIN COATSLion Clothing Co.
166-170 THIRD ST.

PORTLAND, OREGON
C. O. C.
Dec. 7, 16

IT

Should be borne in mind that saving money is the start towards wealth. Every man

CAN'T

Get rich, but everyone can save something. No matter how small your income may be, if you make up your mind to lay up a part of your earnings every week, it may

RAIN

And then rain some more, but with a snug little sum to your credit in the bank you can laugh at hard times and poverty. While the Sun of Prosperity is shining is the time to save for the rainy days that are

ALWAYS

Bound to come. We can help you save; our Savings Department does the business. \$1.00 will start an account. We furnish a bank book and savings bank—free of charge. Start saving today.

The

Bank of Oregon City